

COMBAT COUPLE



When the prime minister, home minister, FBI and Interpol laud someone's efforts, you have to take notice. **Deepak, 45, and Seema, 40, Rao**, both doctors, have trained 15,000 personnel from the armed forces in close combat, free of charge. Heads of state sent the duo letters of appreciation after they distributed their first book, *Encyclopedia of Close Combat Ops*. "The FBI and Interpol said the book is now part of their library," says Deepak, who is a black belt in military martial arts. We salute this team.

Tough Cookie

UK's Indian-origin minister Shriti Vadera, 37, has earned a reputation for driving civil servants to tears. But the Minister for Economic Competitiveness, Small Business and Enterprise will now have to practice a little more diplomacy as she heads to the world stage. Vadera, who's extremely close to Prime Minister Gordon Brown, will now advise South Korea on its presidency of the G20 nations. Vadera, also known as Shriti the Shriek, got the name thanks to her legendary temper. Watch out Seoul.



Baby Talk

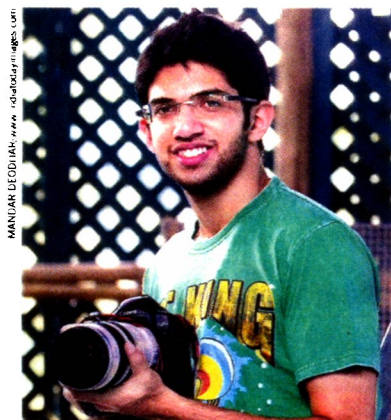
Eyes popped when Padma Lakshmi, 39, dressed in a purple gown, looked fuller than her svelte self at the Emmy Awards. The rumour mill has it that the *Top Chef* host is preggers with her first child. The man in question is Manu Nathan, 27, a lawyer at IMG talent agency, New York, who has been by the model's side for the past year. Looks like they might just be in for the long run.

PADMA LAKSHMI AND MANU NATHAN



GRANDSON RISING

He's being called the Rahul Gandhi of Maharashtra. Aditya Thackeray, 19, grandson of Shiv Sena supremo Bal Thackeray has been frequently seen with father Uddhav at rallies. Apparently he's also played a crucial role in transforming his reticent father's public image. Unlike Rahul who walks village roads, Aditya is reaching out to the urban youth. "It's not appropriate to compare. Our working style is different. I have contributed to the manifesto as I want to help my father and the party," he says. Nothing like starting young.



■ Compiled by Jhilmil Motihar

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